未锈铠
A Knight

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很久很久之前
In Days of Yore TNV-01

The Ninth Virtue
第九条美德

In Days of Yore
很久很久之前

Paimpont Forest
潘蓬特森林

The drizzle, which had fallen for several days without end, stopped just before dark.
连绵数日的细雨，在天黑前停止了。

A horse's hooves thud against the wet earth and moss.
马蹄叩击在湿润的泥土与绿苔之上，发出沉闷的响声。

Dense branches obscure the sky. Occasionally, pheasants and turtledoves swoop across the trail ahead—this is Paimpont Forest.
茂密的山毛榉遮天蔽日，偶尔有野鸡和斑鸠跳过眼前的小径——这里是潘蓬特森林。

Arriving here means their trip is nearing its end.
到达了这里，就意味着这次的行程接近尾声。

Ganelon: Company, halt—we'll make camp here today.
加尼隆：所有人停下——今天我们就在这儿驻扎。

Ganelon: According to the dictates of our order, there is no need to fast today. The deer that Sir Roland hunted can be taken out and roasted.
加尼隆：按规定，今天不必斋戒。先前由罗兰骑士猎下的那只鹿，可以拿出来烤了。

Happy cheers arise from all sides. Only in one corner is there deep silence—there, a figure sits squat.
周围响起了雀跃的欢呼声，唯有一角暗沉的寂静——那是一个蹲坐的人影。

It is Sir Roland, the leader of their band and His Majesty Charlemagne's most trusted defender—soon to be named the Margrave of Brittany to serve as their paramount lord and ruler.
那是罗兰骑士，队伍的领军者，最受查理曼陛下信任的捍卫者，以及——即将成为布列塔尼要塞军事总督的受勋者。

Ganelon: Sir Roland, we expect to arrive at the castle on the morrow ... But sire, if you worry about an ambush, we might continue under the cover of darkness in order to arrive earlier.
加尼隆：罗兰阁下，我们预计在明天就会到达军事要塞……如果你担心有偷袭，也可以趁夜晚行进，尽早到达。

Ganelon: You know—in the eyes of many in Brittany, your head is now worth more than its weight in gold.
加尼隆：你知道的——在布列塔尼人的眼里，你的头颅比等量的黄金更贵重。

The seemingly downcast youth rises to his feet.
看似低落的青年站了起来。

Roland: No, Sir Ganelon, you mistake me.
罗兰：不，加尼隆，你误会了。

Roland: I'm thinking—
罗兰：我是在想——

Roland: What should I say if were to find a deer without any eyes?
罗兰： 你见过没有眼睛的鹿吗?

The question alarms Ganelon, who shakes his head slowly.
熟悉的问法让加尼隆产生了警惕，他缓慢地摇了摇头。

Roland: I have no-eye deer.
罗兰： 是无眼鹿【No idea】。

Ganelon: ...
加尼隆： ……

Ganelon: Sire, enough of these jokes of yours.
加尼隆： 阁下，别再琢磨你的那些笑话了。

Ganelon: As for deer, the buck you hunted will soon be prepared.
加尼隆： 你还记得吗？前几天猎到的那头牡鹿。

Ganelon: Unless you wish to continue eating only bread and beans, I suggest you join us and have some.
加尼隆： 如果你不想继续吃白面包和豌豆，那就过来吧。

Dusk is falling.
暮色四合。

The knights cut down a few cedars near their camp—in the damp weather, only their dry and oily heartwood is sufficient for starting a fire.
骑士们砍伐了一些杉木，用斧子把木材劈成小块——在湿润的天气里，树心的木材干燥且富含油脂，是生火的好材料。

Flames leap up, casting a warm orange glow. A young knight in their company brings over the prepared venison.
火苗燃起，映照出一片暖融融的橙色。
一位见习骑士将处理好的鹿肉端了上来。

Knight I: I've marinated the meat as best I could in our circumstances. If we had fennel and cardamom, we might sprinkle some on while it roasts. The heat would bring out the flavors nicely.
骑士 I： 我把肉块腌好了，如果有茴香和豆蔻，可以在烤的时候撒上，高温会激发它们的风味。

Knight I: Of course, the best spices would be black pepper and cumin ...
骑士 I： 当然，最好的调味料还是黑椒和孜然……

Knight I: But such extravagance ... We'll probably only taste the likes of those spices again when His Majesty deigns to celebrate with us.
骑士 I： 那太奢侈了……也许只有等查理曼陛下为诸位庆功时，才能品尝到这些香料的味道了。

The knights skewer the meat at an angle over the fire pit.
骑士们将肉块以一个斜角插在了火堆旁的土地中。

The buck's fat is rich and heavy. As time passes, it melts in the heat, releasing a wonderful aroma.
肉块中的油脂丰腴厚重。随着时间的推移，它们被高温所融化，散发出美妙的香气。

Rumble—
“咕咕——”

Knight I: My lord, look at how the fat is dripping.
骑士 I： 主啊，这块肉的油脂都溢出来了。

Knight II: I can't even remember the last time I had fresh meat.
骑士 II： ……我已经想不起来上一次吃肉是在什么时候了。

Roland: This morning.
罗兰： 在今天早晨。

Knight II: This morning?
骑士 II： 早晨?

Roland: Did our Lord not transform bread and wine into flesh and blood?
罗兰： 主说过，“这是我的身体和血，是为众人免罪而舍弃和流出的。”

Roland: Tis true. Our morning meal was not the Holy Communion, but if unleavened bread can serve as a fitting vessel for our Lord, it must surely be the equal of any venison.
罗兰： 虽然那并不是一次圣餐礼，但我们确实食用了面包与无酵饼。

A brief, eerie silence follows, only to be broken with a scoff.
一阵短暂、诡异的沉默。

Knight II: Shall I laugh now, or wait until after the cardinal has your head on a pike?
骑士 II： ……您的幽默感总是如此突然，我现在是该笑吗?

Roland: If I have offended, then I beg your pardon.
罗兰： 我深感歉意。

Roland: But let me ask a new question.
罗兰： 但我有一个新的疑惑。

Knight II: Yes, my Lord Margrave?
骑士 II： 罗兰阁下，请说。

Roland: I've told not less than thirteen jokes today, and I must imagine that at least one of them was clever.
罗兰： 我在今天已经连续讲述了十三个笑话，其中不乏一些灵机一动的精妙之作。

Roland: Tell me then, why has no one laughed?
罗兰： 为什么没有人愿意笑一笑呢?

Knight I: Sir Roland, I swear, that pun about the deer was the wittiest I've heard in some time! It was only that in the moment, I forgot to laugh.
骑士 I： 罗兰阁下，我敢发誓，那是我近几天听到过最巧妙的双关语！

Knight I: But I'm afraid I didn't quite catch the meaning of the joke you made about "unleavened bread"?
骑士 I： 只是这个无酵饼的笑话——您愿意解释一下吗?

Roland: Is that so? The cardinal will be busy indeed, young sir. Have you forgotten that the bread of our Communion becomes flesh? So then, our bit of bread this morning could well become meat, if our Lord deigned it so. It is ... a little blasphemous, I must admit.
罗兰： 嗯……当然，无酵饼在圣餐礼中代表着肉。我的意思是，我们在早晨已经吃过肉了——这个幽默基于一点小小的冒犯。

Knight I: Hahahaha!
骑士 I： 哈哈哈哈哈哈哈哈哈！

Knight II: ...
骑士 II： ……

Ganelon: ...
加尼隆： ……

Ganelon: The devil take you, Roland. These jokes of yours are—Not—Funny!
加尼隆： 见鬼，这些笑话根本就不！好！笑！

Ganelon: A lie repeated a thousand times still yet does not become the truth—even if you told forty jokes, not a one would be funny!
加尼隆：谎言即使重复一千遍也不会变成真理——你哪怕说上四十个笑话，也是照样地不好笑！

Roland: Ganelon, I think you must not understand the word "diligence."
罗兰：加尼隆，我认为你对“勤奋”这个词存在误解。

Roland: As the proverb says, "Practice makes perfect." Anything, if pursued persistently enough, will surely lead to success.
罗兰：就像谚语中所说的那样——“熟能生巧”。任何事情，只要足够坚持，一定能有所成就。

Ganelon: Rather than discussing the definition of diligence, I would prefer you not turn yourself into a joke.
加尼隆：……相比于研究勤奋的定义，我更希望你不要把自己变成一个笑话。

Ganelon: "Many small streams make a river." Knights, is there anyone here capable of telling some half-wise decent jokes to our Lord Roland?
加尼隆：“涓涓之水，才能汇成江河。”——骑士们，有人愿意讲点正常的笑话给罗兰阁下听吗?

Knight II: I have one!
骑士 II：让我来！

...
……

This was to be the very first instance of the "Comic Knight Festival."
这是“骑士笑话节”的雏形。

Born on a night in the 8th century, as feast among a band of true companions.
它诞生于公元 8 世纪的一个夜晚，由一群骑士所发起。

Each among them had come from different backgrounds and held various positions, but there was no doubt they could serve as excellent judges.
骑士们的出身各不相同，职位也各有高低，但毫无疑问，他们都是优秀的评委。

After all, a sense of humor doesn't need to be taught. It precedes any rules and structure—the only truth is humor is what makes one laugh.
毕竟，幽默不需要教习，它的存在先于任何规则——每个人天然地具有对幽默的审判力。

As one knight finishes his joke.
一名骑士结束了他的笑话。

Another starts the next.
一名骑士又开始了他的笑话。

And on it goes until, at last, a sprinkle of fennel is scattered over the venison, forming a mouth-watering aroma of citrus and pine gum.
直到有人在鹿肉上撒了一把茴香，它发出了类似柑橘和松脂混合的香气。

Knight I: The meal is ready.
骑士 I：鹿肉可以吃了。

The edges of the meat are charred brown and sizzling with grease.
肉块的边缘已经被烤成了焦褐色，正吱吱地冒着油花。

The young knight turns chef for the evening and smears fresh wild honey on the meat.
见习骑士将新鲜的野蜂蜜抹在了肉块上。

Knight I: My turn.
骑士 I：轮到我说了。

Knight I: Oh, but if only we had a pound of Roquefort cheese ...
骑士 I： 唔，如果有一磅罗奎福特奶酪就好了……

Yet the savory aroma of roasted meat serves as more than enough. He swallows his piece with a satisfied gulp.
不论如何，肉类的焦香总能令人感到放松。他的口腔略感餍足，于是喉头一滚，将鹿肉吞入腹中。

Knight I: Unlike the rest of you, I will tell a proper joke with some theatrical flair, where I shall take on the dramatis personae of one among us.
骑士 I： 和诸位不同，我要讲一个基于假设与扮演的笑话。

Knight I: Though this joke may not be to everyone's tastes, I would use it to express admiration and praise for a worthy hero ...
骑士 I： 虽然这个笑话可能略有失礼与无趣，但我想借此表达自己对英雄人物的向往与赞美……

Then, in a booming practiced voice, he begins his joke.
随后，他用所有人都可以听清楚的音量，开始了他的笑话。

Knight I: There once was a knight both true and faithful, whose great deeds much envy provokes! But where others would boast, his friends were most grateful, that the worst of his faults were his jokes!
骑士 I： 有这样一名骑士，他有着数不清的功绩，却依然乐呵呵地与同僚打成一片，毫无架子。

Knight I: **I speak, of course, of myself! Roland, your liege on the eve of our arrival in Brittany, for soon I will be named—**
骑士 I： **那就是我，即将前往布列塔尼，受封的骑士罗兰——**

Knight I: That is this very day, I ...
骑士 I： 今天，我……

whoosh
“咻——”

Roland: ...!
罗兰： ……！

—An arrow.
——一支箭。

Knight I: Ah—
骑士 I： 啊——

An arrow has pierced through the young knight's throat. The light fades from his eyes as he falls to the ground.
见习骑士喉部中箭，他的眼睛如同鹿肉上正在凝固的油脂，渐渐地失去了光泽。

Ganelon: We're under attack!
加尼隆： ……敌袭！

Roland: Knights, to your swords! Avenge our comrade!
罗兰： 骑士们，拿起你们的剑！为同伴报仇！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

辉光管
Nixie Tube TNV-02

Nixie Tube
辉光管

Somewhere in the Suitcase
箱内一隅

In the hall, a slender plant stands, with green flower buds clinging to its stalk.
厅中，草本植物摇曳着它纤长的枝叶，嫩青色的花穗还攀附在柔软的茎秆上。

Its branches sway in a metered rhythm.
它们以恒定的节律摇晃着。

Oliver Fog : Here's what happened.
雾行者：……事情是这样的。

Oliver Fog : A few days ago, I asked A Knight to tell me the story of Pepin the Short.
雾行者：前几天，我想让未锈铠先生给我讲讲丕平三世的故事。

Oliver Fog : So I knocked on the door to his room, but no one answered. Then I went to check the patio, but he wasn't there either.
雾行者：我敲了他的房门，没有人应声，我又找遍了庭院，他也不在。

Oliver Fog : Next, I asked Vertin, but ... She didn't know either.
雾行者：于是我询问了维尔汀小姐，但……她也并不知情。

An-an Lee: Ah! I understand, Sir Fog! So you want to know where Sir Knight has gone.
泥鳐的士：啊～我懂你啦，雾 sir！你是想知道铠 sir 去哪儿了？

An-an Lee: Well, it is true I am the very best when it comes to ghost hunting! But Sir Knight is not exactly a ghost. He's more of a haunting character ...
泥鳐的士：捉鬼我最擅长啦！不过铠 sir 他不算鬼喔，他应该算“日用品”那类……

Oliver Fog : Apologies, I suppose I don't quite understand your arcane skill, but ... perhaps you still have a knack for finding people.
雾行者：抱歉，我对你的神秘术并不了解，但……也许你有什么找人的诀窍。

Oliver Fog fishes out a few Sharpodonties from his pocket.
雾行者从口袋里摸出几个利齿子儿。

Oliver Fog : This is work. I know the rules.
雾行者：——这是工作，我明白规矩。

Oliver Fog : I did not prepare much, but maybe I can pay a deposit first.
雾行者：我的准备不多，但也许可以先支付定金。

An-an Lee: Huh? What's this?
泥鳐的士：咦？这是？

It dawns on her.
她恍然大悟。

An-an Lee: Oh, how generous! In that case, I'll certainly help you.
泥鳐的士：哇，老板豪气！我一定帮你帮到底。

An-an Lee: Besides catching ghosts, asking Lord Lao Zi for a little direction is a simple matter ...
泥鳐的士：捉不得鬼，帮你问下太上老君也是 easy job 啦……

She takes the two pieces from Oliver's hand.
她从雾行者的手心取走了其中的两枚。

An-an Lee: And it is a kind gesture to help out a friend ...
泥鳐的士：帮朋友忙，自然是友情价……

An-an Lee: Hm, what was it that Grandma taught me again?
泥鳐的士：唔，阿婆怎么教我的来着?

An-an Lee: Whatever. As long as you truly believe it, that's all that matters!
泥鳐的士：……算了，心诚则灵就好了嘛!

An-an Lee cups three arcade tokens in her hands, clasping them together and shaking them forcefully.
泥鳐的士用手拢起三个游戏厅的硬币，合掌之后，用力地摇晃着。

An-an Lee: Spirits of heaven and earth ...
泥鳐的士：天灵灵，地灵灵……

Oliver Fog : ...
雾行者：……

Oliver Fog : At first, I thought A Knight might have been on a mission outside ... So, I specifically asked Ms. Vertin.
雾行者：我一度怀疑未锈铠先生在外执行任务……为此，我特地询问了维尔汀小姐。

Oliver Fog : But Ms. Vertin said that A Knight hasn't been on any missions recently.
雾行者：但维尔汀小姐说过，未锈铠先生近日并没有外派任务。

Oliver Fog : But he had asked Vertin for several days of leave.
雾行者：不过，他向维尔汀请了很多天的假。

Oliver Fog : I wonder if he has some important matters to attend to?
雾行者：——是有什么重要的事情需要去处理吗?

An-an Lee: Hm ... yes, I see him!
泥鳐的士：嗯……我倒是有看到他噢!

The young ghost hunter begins her soothsaying.
年轻的占卜师开始了回忆。

An-an Lee: I see that Sir Knight is as he was before. He still loves telling those dreadful jokes.
泥鳐的士：铠 sir 呢，还是同以前一样，爱讲那些古灵精怪的笑话。

An-an Lee: But—it seems he has been collecting something recently! They look like small colorful banners and trumpets ...
泥鳐的士：不过——他最近好像在收集一些东西哦！像什么小彩旗、小号角……

An-an Lee: It's not clear to me what he's doing!
泥鳐的士：也不知道他要做什么!

She stops her hands and examines the answer the coins give.
她停下了手，观看硬币们所给出的答案。

An-an Lee: Hmm ...
泥鳐的士：嗯……

An-an Lee: The first hexagram, Lesser Yin; the second hexagram, Lesser Yang ...
泥鳐的士：第一爻，少阴；第二爻，少阳……

An-an Lee: The sixth hexagram, Old Yin ... Changing to the Hexagram of Earth over Water.
泥鳐的士：第六爻，老阴……地水师，上六变卦。

An-an Lee falls silent.
泥鳐的士陷入沉思。

An-an Lee: Oh, ho!
泥鰔的士：哦呦！

She has learned her grandma's exaggerated manner of shouting.
她学着记忆里阿婆的样子夸张地大叫着。

An-an Lee: Oh dear, that's terrible, Sir Fog!
泥鰔的士：大镬啦，雾 sir！

Oliver Fog : What does all of this mean?
雾行者：这是?

An-an Lee: The Hexagram of Earth over Water shows that Sir Knight is going to war and that the war will be both unpredictable and hazardous.
泥鰔的士：地水师，说明铠 sir 要去打仗，这个仗会打得状况百出，前途堪忧啊。

An-an Lee: And this changing of the Hexagram shows ... there may be traitors among Sir Knight's forces, so he must be extra cautious.
泥鰔的士：而这个上六变卦……说明铠 sir 的军队里可能有反骨仔哦，要加倍小心才行。

Oliver Fog : Going to war?
雾行者：……打仗?

Oliver Fog : In the suitcase?
雾行者：在箱子里?

Oliver Fog : This sounds rather more like a tall tale ...
雾行者：这听起来更像是故事……

An-an Lee: Hmm ... The war indicated in the hexagram isn't some mere skirmish.
泥鰔的士：唔……卦象上显示的打仗，不是普通的小打小闹哦。

The branches of the potted plant stop their rhythm and begin to tremble.
恒定的节律消失了，盆栽中的花枝微不可察地颤抖着。

And though perhaps it is only old circuits, the fluorescent lights in the hall begin to flicker faintly.
也许是电路老化，大厅中的辉光管正以一个微弱的频率闪烁。

The orange light in the vision pulses slowly, like twilight in a memory.
橙色的光芒缓缓涌动，如同一次追忆中的黄昏。

Oliver Fog : Perhaps ...
雾行者：难道……

The pair look at each other.
二人面面相觑。

Oliver Fog : ... Ms. An-an, do you know what era it is outside right now?
雾行者：……安安小姐，你知道外面现在是什么时代吗?

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

俏皮话城邦
A Burg of Quips TNV-03

A Burg of Quips
俏皮话城邦

Roland wrings out the water that is pooling on the hem of his clothes.
罗兰拧干衣摆上的积水。

Roland: Rain again ...
罗兰：又是下雨……

Roland: Hmph ... Where is everyone?
罗兰：呼……人呢?

The trail left by their attacker had disappeared.
偷袭者留下的痕迹消失了。

And his fellow knights had disappeared along with it.
同行者也随之不见了。

Roland: Hm?
罗兰：嗯?

Hoof beats tramp across the mud nearby.
远处传来了马蹄声。

He holds his breath and listens.
他屏息凝神。

The figure of a knight appears in the distance, causing Roland to draw his sword defensively.
远方出现了一个骑士的身影，于是他抽出了剑。

???: ... Roland?
???: ……罗兰?

Roland: Oliver! You nearly drove me out of my wits!
罗兰：奥利弗！你吓死我了！

Oliver: Haha ...
奥利弗：哈哈……

Roland mounts his horse, and the pair ride side by side in the rain.
二人在雨中并肩而行，进行了简短的交流。

Oliver: So—
奥利弗：所以——

Oliver: Was it really Ganelon who suggested a festival of jokes? He doesn't seem the type to enjoy comedy.
奥利弗：加尼隆提议举办笑话节？他不是喜欢讲笑话的人。

Oliver: Then no sooner than our comrade had called himself "Roland," he was struck dead in the attack ...
奥利弗：而那名见习骑士，是自称“罗兰”之后，才遇袭死去……

Roland: It is as I said, there is great power in a joke.
罗兰：我说了，没有人会抗拒笑话。

Roland: They can inspire morale while marching or on the eve of battle.
罗兰：在行军之时，适当地讲笑话有助于鼓舞士气。

Roland: I can remember many a time when a well-timed joke has done much to lift the spirits of a weary band.
罗兰：就比如那时，虽然是充满疲惫的行军过程，但因为有笑话存在，骑士们反而充满了精神与斗志。

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Oliver: If I may speak out of turn, my friend. I feel I must tell you something.
奥利弗：这可能很失礼，但我必须得告诉你一个事实。

Oliver: Roland, bosom friend, I think perhaps your jokes serve only one purpose.
奥利弗：罗兰，你讲的笑话只在一种情况下特别好用。

Oliver: To inspire a timely retreat.
奥利弗：那就是准备撤退的时候。

Roland: I regret only that my love for comedy as yet outstretches my talent.
罗兰：我对此深表遗憾。

Oliver: You should know, I suspect a traitor among our fellowship. If they plan to strike again, their next move will be in Paimpont Forest.
奥利弗：实际上，我正在追查骑士中的叛徒，情报上说，他们的下一次行动就在潘蓬特森林。

Oliver: They will not make the same mistake twice—we must move with haste.
奥利弗：这样看来，他们的袭击已经发生了——我们得快点回去。

Oliver: Regardless, I'm heartened to see you are safe—may our Lord continue to protect you, Roland.
奥利弗：不论如何，庆幸你安全地到达了这里——主保佑你，罗兰。

He reaches out to pat his friend's shoulder.
他伸出手，想拍拍好友的肩膀，以示欢迎。

But in a flash, Roland draws his sword and swings in a fierce motion towards Oliver's ear.
罗兰忽然抽出了剑，向着奥利弗的耳边猛力一击。

Oliver: D**n it!
奥利弗：该死！

The blade catches the arrow mid-flight, cutting it in twain.
一根箭在奥利弗的耳边被劈成两截。

Roland: Ride for the forest. We'll talk about the rest later.
罗兰：看见前面的森林了吗？先进去，其他的事一会再说。

Hearkening to his liege's orders, Oliver bends down, grasping the horse's belly with his legs, and spurs it into a gallop towards the forest.
说完，他伏低身体，双腿用力地一夹马腹，向着眼前的森林冲了进去。

But a second arrow reaches them first, piercing the destrier's leg and spilling both horse and rider on the ground.
奥利弗的马被斜飞而来的箭支射中了跟腱，脱力扑倒。

Oliver falls hard on his leg and lays stunned on the ground.
马的躯体重重地压在了奥利弗的腿上。

Oliver: —!!!
奥利弗：——！！！

Roland: ...
罗兰：……

Attacker I: It's Oliver!
偷袭者 Ⅰ： 是奥利弗！

The attacker grins and raises the sword in his hand.
偷袭者欣喜若狂，他狞笑着举起了手中的大剑。

Attacker I: His head won't be as valuable as Roland, still ...
偷袭者 Ⅰ： 虽然没有罗兰那么值钱，但……

The lumbering figure's shadow engulfs Oliver's body.
硕大的阴影吞噬了奥利弗的身躯。

Roland: Careful—
罗兰： 小心——

Roland rides swiftly, holding high his Everlasting Sword. With a single stroke, he cleaves the shadow in two.
罗兰策马而来，他抡起了恒常之剑，仅一个错身，就将那片阴影劈为两段。

A short, stiff cry gives way to the sudden wash of warm liquid that spills out over Oliver.
伴随着惨叫，奥利弗的衣摆被喷溅而来的温热液体浇透了。

Attacker II: D**n it ...
偷袭者 Ⅱ： 该死的……

Attacker II: Why are you retreating?! There are but two of them!
偷袭者 Ⅱ： 你们往后退什么?！他们只有两个人！

Attacker II: Ulch—
偷袭者 Ⅱ： 呃——

There is a sudden coldness in the attacker's throat.
喉头一凉。

His vision begins to spin, a dizzying sensation as he falls to the ground.
——视野不断旋转着，周围的景物逐渐变得昏暗。

Attacker II: ...
偷袭者 Ⅱ： ……

From the ground, he sees his own headless corpse slouching off the back of his horse.
他看见自己的马背上坐着一个无头的躯体。

Roland: Quick, Oliver, take my hand—
罗兰： 快，奥利弗，抓住我的手——

The salt from the blood is stinging his eyes. Oliver forces them to open.
奥利弗勉强张开眼睛，血水里的盐分让他的眼睛感到蛰痛。

In the blurred vision, he catches sight of Roland's figure and reaches out his hand toward him.
残余的视野捕捉到了罗兰的影子，于是他伸出了手。

Oliver: They'll be expecting us to move forward, further into their ambush. Don't follow the path they're driving us towards ... Go around!
奥利弗： 小心伏击，不要沿着他们驱赶我们的路线走……绕过去！

Roland grasps his comrade and hoists him up onto his horse.
罗兰握住他的手，一把将他拽上了自己的马背。

Roland: Not to worry, young Oliver. I'm no fresh squire.
罗兰： 老伙计，放心吧，我当然知道！

The horse carries the two knights deep into the forest.
马载着两名骑士，闯入了森林的深处。

The rain grows heavier, and its rhythmic tapping gradually swallows up all other sounds.
雨势渐大，逐渐地吞没了所有的声音。

Roland: Ah, this little cave here will serve as an able refuge through the rain.
罗兰：瞧，这是我刚刚发现的角落……那头鹿最后就是在这儿被我抓住的。

Oliver: A cave? Perhaps you should check inside for wild beasts first ...
奥利弗：角落？你得看看里面有没有野兽……

The pain still keeps him from seeing straight.
他想要张开眼睛看看情况。

Roland: No need to fret. We'll be safe in here. Come now. Let's see about your shoulder and leg.
罗兰：好极了！奥利弗，这儿很安全。来吧，看看你的肩膀和腿。

They stash themselves in the hollow cave, lying down on a bed of damp green moss.
昏暗潮湿的森林一角，土地长着一层苍绿色的苔藓。

Roland draws his long sword and severs the shaft of an errant arrow still clinging harmlessly to his armor.
罗兰抽出了长剑，劈断了箭支的木杆。

Oliver: Did you hear those hooves, not far in the distance?
奥利弗：——你听到那些马蹄声了吗?

Oliver: Almost twenty men were chasing us—every one of them equipped with armor, swords, and a cordon of arrows.
奥利弗：几乎有二十个人，和我们一起进入了林子——每一个人都装备精良，盔甲、铁剑，还有足量的箭。

Roland: But we're still alive, Oliver.
罗兰：但我们现在还活着，奥利弗。

Oliver: ... So? There is danger here, Roland—it's not just about our immediate crisis.
奥利弗：……所以呢？危机还存在，罗兰——甚至远不止眼前的危机。

Oliver: Someone wants you to die here.
奥利弗：有人要你死在这里。

An eerie silence falls over the forest, as if the rain has hushed itself.
氛围突然陷入了诡异的沉默。

Roland: Oliver, look.
罗兰：奥利弗，你看。

Oliver: What?
奥利弗：什么?

Roland: There's an Arachne.
罗兰：那里有一只阿拉克尼【Arachne】。

Oliver's neck goes rigid.
奥利弗的脖子变得僵硬。

It is a venomous spider critter, one that prefers to nest in damp, dark places.
那是一种剧毒的蛛状魔精，喜欢栖息在潮湿的阴暗处。

He looks slowly in the direction of Roland's gaze—
他缓缓地朝着罗兰目光方向看去——

Roland has folded his hands together, shaping them like a spider, crawling through the air.
罗兰将两只手合并在一起。它们比成蜘蛛状，在空中无畏地爬行着。

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Oliver: Ro-land!
奥利弗：罗、兰！

Oliver cannot stand it anymore. He slams his fist down hard on the ground.
奥利弗再也忍受不住了，他重重地一拳砸在了地上。

Oliver: How many times do we have to tell you—these jokes of ours are not funny!
奥利弗：你还要我和你说多少次——这些笑话根本一点都不好笑！

Oliver: Our foes number twenty at least, likely more with reinforcements ... And there are only the two of us!
奥利弗：二十多个装备精良的敌人，极有可能另有增援……而我和你只有两个人！

Oliver: Tell me how you manage to conjure these horrid jokes in a situation like this?!
奥利弗：这种情况下……你告诉我，你为什么还能讲出这个该死的笑话！

Roland: I thought you needed something to raise your mood.
罗兰：哦，我以为你会需要它。

Oliver: It's only managed to raise my ire!
奥利弗：闭嘴！

Oliver: Roland, my liege ... allow me to suggest what we should do now ...
奥利弗：我告诉你，我们现在该做些什么……

A plan is forming in his mind, one that seems to ease his pain.
他的脑海中已经有了计划的雏形。

Oliver: They know that you were to reach Brittany today.
奥利弗：他们知道你今日将要抵达布列塔尼。

Oliver: But they didn't know that I would ride here to receive you.
奥利弗：但是，他们不知道我会临时起意，来这里迎接你。

Oliver: If the worst should come to pass, you may be able to escape by wearing my cloak ...
奥利弗：所以，即使是最差的情况，你也可以从这里逃离，只需要穿上我的披风……

There is a second flash of genius on his face.
灵光一现。

Oliver: Yes—
奥利弗：是的——

Oliver: This could well be our best opportunity to expose the traitor ...
奥利弗：只要能够合理地运用这个机会，一定能够抓出那个叛徒……

Though the traitor's identity is not difficult for them to guess. He has known the answer for a while.
叛徒的身份并不难猜测，他内心早有答案。

Roland: It is a sound plan, young Oliver. But I refuse it. If I should do as you say, then only one of us can leave.
罗兰：实际上，我也不认可你刚刚的计划，这意味着我们之中只能离开一个。

Oliver: A plan that lets one of us escape is better than both of us dying here.
奥利弗：相比于两个人都死在这里，让其中一个人逃出去的计划显然更明智。

Roland: ...
罗兰：……

Oliver: Don't tell me you're going out there by yourself.
奥利弗：别告诉我你不打算叫援军回来。

A familiar trumpet sounds far in the distance.
远方忽然响起了呜咽的号角声。

Oliver: Enemies!
奥利弗：敌人！

Roland: Friends!
罗兰：援军！

They shout in a clashing unison.
他们两个异口同声地说道。

Roland: Did that arrow hit your ear after all? That was clear as day the sound of Lady Oder's trumpet call!
罗兰：你的耳朵怎么回事，连奥德的号角声都听不出来?

Oliver: A trumpet is just an instrument. Anyone can blow it.
奥利弗：号角只是一个物品，谁都可以吹响它。

Oliver: Besides, what if Oder has been captured? What if the attackers and Oder simply have the same sort of trumpet?
奥利弗：万一奥德被俘虏了呢？万一偷袭者和奥德是在同一家商店里购买的号角呢?

Roland: Forget it then. There's no use arguing about something you can hear with your own ears. Besides, if not Oder, who else would blow a trumpet like that?
罗兰：得了吧，用耳朵就可以听出来的东西，有什么可吵的。除了奥德，还有谁会那样地吹号角?

Roland: She's your sister, and still you cannot recognize her?
罗兰：她还是你的亲妹妹，你一点都不了解她。

Oliver: That may be her, yes, but is it not prudent to consider the other possibilities?
奥利弗：但你是不是应该考虑更多的可能性?

Oliver: Indeed, I dare not question His Majesty's decree, but seeing you, our Lord Margrave, reduced to hiding in a cave, I must admit my fear for the future of Brittany.
奥利弗：……诚然我不应该质疑陛下的决定，但看到你这个样子的总督，我有些担忧布列塔尼要塞的未来了。

The Margrave?
军事总督?

It dawns on him.
他想通了。

Roland: You have the right of it.
罗兰：你说得对。

Oliver: Great, then we do as I suggested ...
奥利弗：太好了，那就按照我说的……

Roland: Knight Oliver, I order you to stay here.
罗兰：奥利弗骑士，我命令你留守此处。

Roland: Once the danger is gone and you are able, you are to travel to Brittany and relay what has happened here.
罗兰：直到危险消失，你才可以前往布列塔尼，转达这里的消息。

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Roland: Should events transpire that lead to my death, I will recommend that you succeed me as the Margrave of Brittany.
罗兰：假如我不幸遇难，我将举荐你成为新的军事总督。

Roland: Don't worry. I'll pen a letter to His Majesty, listing a few of the reasons for "making Sir Oliver your trusted Margrave." I'll use all the most colorful rhetoric at my disposal.
罗兰：不用担心，我会写一封信件，向陛下罗列几条“关于奥利弗骑士成为总督”的必要性，用上我所掌握的最华丽的辞藻。

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Oliver: I think you've confused our situation for a fairy tale, my Lord Margrave.
奥利弗：你是不是骑士小说看多了?

Oliver: Suppose you die out there, Roland, on whatever fool heroic you're planning, and I survive to present your letter of recommendation to His Majesty's Court ...
奥利弗：假设你死在了这里，我活了下来，并且拿着你的举荐信，呈贡给那些大人物。

Oliver: What do you earnestly think they would do if I were to show up in your place?
奥利弗：你觉得他们会怎么做?

Roland: I'm very sure, after reading through my glowing recommendation, they would grant you the title of Margrave of Brittany.
罗兰：在经过短暂的讨论后，他们会让你在布列塔尼受封为军事总督。

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Oliver: I see now why His Majesty so appreciates your honest nature, Sir Roland.
奥利弗：也许陛下就是欣赏你这种单纯的脑筋。

Oliver: But think seriously, surely they would start to wonder why I decided to ride out to meet you.
奥利弗：事实上，他们只会开始猜忌，为什么我会心血来潮地迎接你。

Oliver: And the why-fores and whens of how you died, and how it came to be that there was no one else around to witness your death.
奥利弗：为什么你死的时候，身边除了我再无他人。

Oliver: If I were then to present a letter of your recommendation, how would it be received?
奥利弗：偏偏还在此刻留下了举荐我为军事总督的书信。

Roland: You are suggesting they would think you forged the letter. Perhaps even that you orchestrated this ambush.
罗兰：你的意思是，他们会以为信件是你伪造的？而这场袭击，也是你策划的?

Roland: You think too poorly of His Majesty's Court. The Paladins of Charlemagne are good and just.
罗兰：你把他们想得太坏了。

Oliver: Roland, you can't just split people into simple categories of "good" and "evil."
奥利弗：罗兰，你不能用简单的“好”和“坏”去衡量一个人。

Oliver: People are complicated, and men of power more complicated still—you should know that far better than I do.
奥利弗：人是相当复杂的，尤其是那些政治家——你应该比我更了解这些。

Oliver: Besides ...
奥利弗：更何况……

He falls silent again.
他再次地沉默了。

The weight of the accusation bore on him, to accuse one of their brethren of treachery, he hesitates to continue.
这是一个埋藏已久的怀疑，他从未告诉过任何人。

Roland pats his shoulder.
罗兰拍了拍他的肩膀。

Roland: Go on.
罗兰：说下去。

Oliver: The traitor must be one of the other Paladins, one of your brothers in Charlemagne's court.
奥利弗：经过我的调查和猜测，我们一直以来苦苦找寻的叛徒，极有可能是十二骑士之一。

A sharp stab of pain throbs in his shoulder. Oliver takes a deep breath before continuing.
肩膀处传来一阵剧痛，奥利弗深吸了一口气。

Oliver: It is Ganelon of Mainz.
奥利弗：他就是美因茨的**加尼隆**【Ganelon】。

Roland breaks into a grin.
罗兰忽然露出了一个笑容。

Roland: That's reassuring, Oliver.
罗兰：太令人感到欣慰了，奥利弗。

Roland: You finally learned how to make a joke.
罗兰：你终于学会了讲笑话。

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Roland: Oh ... Don't misunderstand. There is weight to your speculation.
罗兰：噢……别着急，我认同你的猜测。

Roland: But, it's a matter of proof ...
罗兰：但还是之前的问题，关于证据……

The trumpet sounds out once again, now much closer than before.
远方的号角声由远及近地响起了。

Before long, a party of knights emerges from the surrounding forest, led by a woman.
没过多久，丛林中钻出了一队骑士，为首的女骑士身姿挺拔。

Oder: Oh—Sir Roland, how did you end up here?
奥德：噢——罗兰阁下，你怎么在这儿?

Oder: Don't worry, old friend. My men made short work of your would-be assassins—we even managed to seize them alive, the lion's share at any rate.
奥德：别担心，外面的那些人已经被骑士们全部捉住了——我特意让他们留了活口。

Oder: The both of you look worse for wear; we must make for the castle quickly.
奥德：——你们伤得很重，我们得快些回去。

Oder: But first ... A question!
奥德：但在此之前……提问！

Oder: What did the blanket say to the bed?
奥德：毯子对床说了什么?

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Roland answers without missing a beat.
罗兰不假思索地回答。

Roland: I've got you covered.
罗兰：别担心，我掩护你！【I got you covered.】

Oder: Aha! Precisely! I've got you covered!
奥德：啊哈！答对了！我来掩护你们了！

Oliver: ...
奥利弗：……

Brittany Fortress
布列塔尼亚要塞

The rain washes down the narrow streets of the castle town.
雨水洗刷了布列塔尼要塞的街道。

The smells of blood from the butcher shop, of ammonia from the tannery, and the reek of old sweat that had long lingered there are swept out by the arrival of the rain.
屠宰场中飘动的血腥味、皮革作坊中苛性碱的气息，以及街道上终日不散的汗酸臭气，随着雨水的降临而消失殆尽。

But no pleasant scent of earth and stone greets her. The reek of fish clings on in wet weather, as bits of fish covered in scales float on the puddles over Oder's feet.
唯有鱼腥味还在蔓延。一副沾着鱼鳞的鱼肚肠顺着水流漂到了奥德的脚边，被她一脚踢开。

Oder: We need someone charismatic to lead the interrogation. May I propose the Knight of Astorford?
奥德：得让一个有亲和力的人前来扮演好人，您觉得阿斯托尔福骑士怎么样?

Oder: Should he fail to win them over with charm, then we must rely on Lord Reynaud to break them.
奥德：至于那个坏人，毋庸置疑地就是雷诺德阁下了。

Oder: But to have these two noblemen come to interrogate such a prisoner ...
奥德：但让这两位阁下前来审讯这样一个犯人……

Oliver: There's no need to involve them, my lady. We have our own manner of guile to make the brigand talk.
奥利弗：不，只是一个没有姓氏的偷袭者，用不上去请那两位大人。

Oliver: For now, let us take Roland to rest. I believe the journey has finally caught up to him.
奥利弗：……带着罗兰去休息吧，他的脸色就像一个快要腐烂的苹果。

Roland, at last exhausted from his journey and battle, begins to slump in his saddle. The voices around him grow fainter.
罗兰努力地听着四周的言语，但那声音还是不可避免地微弱了下去。

Until all sound blends into the patter of the rain.
逐渐被一种更为恒久的鸣响代替。

He closes his eyes, and darkness swallows everything like a tide.
他闭上眼睛，黑暗如潮水一般吞没了一切。

thud, thud, thud
“笃、笃、笃。”

Oliver Fog : Oof!
雾行者： 呜——！

An-an Lee: Whoa ...!
泥鳐的士： 哇啊……！

A Knight's Room
未锈铠房间

The two of them barge through the door and tumble into the sunlit room.
因急切而推搡的二人打着滚儿进入了这个洒落着阳光的房间。

APPLe: Oh! You have some visitors.
APPLe： 哦！您多了两位新访客。

An-an Lee: Ah, Sir Knight, so you've been in your room this whole time!
泥鳐的士： 哇，铠 sir，原来你就在屋子里！

An-an Lee: Hmph, then all that fuss about the lights was just old circuits. Ms. Vertin should hire an electrician!
泥鳐的士： 哼哼，我都说的啦，那个一定是电路老化，维 sir 要请电工咯！

A Knight: There's no need for concern. Someone is here, as they have been for some time.
未锈铠： 造成了误会，真是万分抱歉。无需担忧，某人状态良好。

APPLe: APPLe can attest to this. We preferred to use just the sunlight in this room, as it created a very dramatic lighting effect for Mr. Knight.
APPLe： APPLe 某可以作证。阳光在未锈铠先生身上所呈现的折射角恰到好处。

APPLe: We're holding a bit of a storytelling session.
APPLe： 我们只是在举办一个小型的、简单的故事会。

A Knight: Quite so. Someone was just in the middle of a story about Sir Roland ... However, Sir APPLe here seems to believe that one's storytelling skills are lacking—
未锈铠： 正是如此。某人正在讲一个关于罗兰骑士的故事……然而 APPLe 先生认为，某人讲故事的水平有所欠缺——

A Knight: Someone has been attempting to portray the figure of a knight named Roland in order to immerse the audience in the moment.
未锈铠： 所以，某人正试图扮演这位名叫罗兰的骑士，以便于让听众们身临其境。

The knight's gauntlets spread and lower on both sides, approximating a theatrical bow.
亮闪闪的手甲向两侧摊开。

A Knight: Someone is pleased that you happened by.
未锈铠： 两位新朋友，某人欢迎你们的到来。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

样子货
Decoration TNV-04

Decoration
样子货

A Knight: Since you're here, please take a seat. Someone could use a more ... enthusiastic audience for this tale.
未锈铠：既然来了，请先坐下吧——现在正是缺听众的时候。

Just as Ms. Sotheby's room is filled with collector's edition Typhon dolls, and Ms. Eternity's TV plays "The Night Show" all night ...
正如苏芙比小姐的房间中摆满了珍藏版提丰玩偶，温妮弗雷德女士的电视中彻夜播放的《今晚秀》——

In this room, there are various items that highlight their owner's tastes.
这个房间中，有着各式各样能够凸显其主人品味的小东西。

Weapons in their scabbards and a yellowed book on the desk—recognizable from the cover as a collection of very old jokes.
剑架上的兵器，桌子上摆放着的泛黄书本——从封皮上依稀能看出是一本笑话集。

In the corner stands a large pot of lard, and, next to it, the fireplace is burning low.
墙角摆放着一大罐油脂，而不远处，壁炉正缓缓地燃烧着。

An-an Lee: Sir Knight! You can't put fat next to a flame! It'll catch fire!
泥鳐的士：铠 sir！油不能放在火旁边！会火烛的！

A Knight: Don't worry, Ms. An-an. This flame is only a memory. It is constant, gentle, and does not produce heat nor possess a desire to burn anything.
未锈铠：不用担心，安安小姐，这丛火焰来源于某人的追忆。它恒定、温和，不会产生过多的热量和烧灼一切的野心。

A Knight touches the flames with his hand, and they nuzzle his fingers like a tame colt.
未锈铠用手去触碰火焰，火焰围绕着他的手指，如同一只温驯的良驹。

An-an Lee: Well, that proves little, Sir Knight. Of course you aren't afraid of being burned. You're only a suit of armor!
泥鳐的士：铠 sir，你是盔甲嘛，有话说是“真金唔怕红炉火”——你当然不怕火烧。

On one side of the room, there is a pile of assorted trumpets; the desk is covered with colorful flags—too many perhaps, rendering a messy scene.
屋子的一侧，堆满了各式的小号角；桌子上摆满了缤纷的彩旗——数量太多，显得颇为凌乱。

A nimble hand grasps a carving of a green bird, gently adjusting its orientation.
一只灵活的手揽住了绿色的小鸟木雕，轻轻地调整了它的朝向。

An-an Lee: What are all these ornaments for? Have you considered rearranging them? The Feng Shui of this room has a lot to be desired.
泥鳐的士：这些摆件是做什么用的？换一个方向摆，屋子里的风水会更靓仔哦。

A Knight: These are all things Someone has prepared in anticipation of the Comic Knight Festival.
未锈铠：这些是某人为了“骑士笑话节”准备的东西。

Oliver Fog : The Comic Knight Festival?
雾行者：骑士笑话节?

A Knight: An event inspired by an old friend.
未锈铠：受到故人的启发，某人觉得这样的形式相当有趣。

A Knight: Simply put, this is a joke-telling festival—everyone sits around together, drawing lots to take turns telling their jokes.
未锈铠：简单来说，这是一个说笑话的节日——所有的人围坐在一起，按照抽签的轮次，依次说出自己的笑话。

A Knight: If you can't come up with a joke, then you must tell an interesting story instead.
未锈铠：如果实在讲不出笑话，也可以说些有趣的故事。

A Knight: As for this wooden carving, there is a mechanism one can find on the bottom.
未锈铠：至于这个木雕，某人特地在它的底部安装了一个机关。

A Knight stretches out a finger and lightly fiddles with the tail feathers.
未锈铠伸出手指，轻轻地拨弄了一下尾羽。

Resplendent Quetzal Carving: *click, clack*
绿咬鹃木雕：咔哒咔哒——

The small bird begins to move, rocking backwards and forwards. After a moment, the yellowish beak stops in front of Oliver Fog.
小鸟开始转动，片刻之后，淡黄色的鸟喙停在了雾行者的面前。

A Knight: If this were the Comic Knight Festival, the next speaker would be Oliver Fog.
未锈铠：假如此时是“骑士笑话节”，接下来的讲述者就是雾行者先生。

Oliver Fog : It sounds as if it wouldn't be a half-bad event.
雾行者：这或许会是个有趣的活动。

Oliver Fog : But everyone here has so many of their own matters to attend to.
雾行者：但箱子里的各位都有各自的要事。

Oliver Fog : Ms. Vertin almost never has time off because of the "Storm."
雾行者：维尔汀小姐也因为“暴雨”几乎没有休息时间。

Oliver Fog : I can't imagine most people will have time to attend a comedy festival.
雾行者：大部分人都不会有时间来参加这个笑话节。

Oliver Fog : Though, certainly, this place could use a little levity.
雾行者：……说真的，我们需要假期。

A Knight: It is precisely because of the present state of things that Someone felt inspired to recreate this old festival.
未锈铠：因为大家总是忙个不停，某人才想要复兴这个节日。

A Knight: It has not gone unnoticed to anyone, let alone Someone, that the laughter and smiles that once frequented this hall have now all but disappeared.
未锈铠：不知诸位有没有发现，笑声与笑容，似乎都从大家的脸上消失了。

A Knight: Someone was recounting to Mr. APPLe one's recollection of the tales of ancient knights and the origins of the festival.
未锈铠：于是某人正在分享一些关于骑士的轶事——作为笑话节的预演。

A Knight: Someone hoped that these stories could be shared to help everyone regain a sense of humor in the face of great danger—or, if nothing less, provide some momentary distraction.
未锈铠：希望这些故事能够帮助诸位重拾幽默感——至少，放松一下紧绷着的神经。

An-an Lee: Wow! So not just jokes but story-telling too?
泥鳐的士：哇哦！讲评书噶?

APPLe: Another event to add to the Comic Knight Festival!
APPLe：为骑士笑话节增加剧目?

APPLe: This APPLe certainly hopes it will inspire our friends to hear these tales of knightly heroics.
APPLe： 这也许有助于骑士精神的宣传。

A Knight: Undoubtedly so. Someone recalls a story that was recounted to Mr. X some short while ago.
未锈铠： 不久前，某人为 X 先生讲述了一个在萨拉戈萨发生的故事。

A Knight: In that story, a slightly reckless knight, Sir Roland, along with his good friend Oliver, paid a visit to Bramimonde, Queen of the Moors ...
未锈铠： 在那个故事中，稍显莽撞的骑士罗兰与他的密友奥利弗，一起拜谒摩尔人的女王布拉米蒙德……

A Knight: The journey was fraught with difficulty, but, fortunately, came to a happy ending.
未锈铠： 虽然过程状况百出，但所幸有一个不错的结果。

A Knight: Hmm ...
未锈铠： 嗯……

Sunlight scatters against the floor as a breeze blows through the treetops.
阳光斜照，窗外有微风拂过树梢。

A Knight: Such fine weather makes Someone think of ancient times past, on a sunny day in the south of Provence.
未锈铠： 这样好的天气，让某人想起了数百年前的一个下午。

A Knight: Back then, Someone would often share a drink with old friends, whiling away the afternoon.
未锈铠： 那个时候，某人常与故友们一起共享茶点。

A Knight: One of them was a very heroic woman, one whom Someone greatly admired.
未锈铠： 其中有一位十分英勇的女骑士。某人十分敬佩她。

A Knight: Among her greatest feats was when she fought a battle against a giant named Felgert.
未锈铠： 她曾经与一位名叫菲尔格特的巨人鏖战不休。

A Knight: Though the records of history did not record much of her story, a travesty most deeply unfair.
未锈铠： 历史上并没有记载她的功绩，某人为她深感不平。

A Knight: In fact, Sir Roland was involved in the battle as well. Someone recalls it vividly. A dramatic tale, which Ms. Charlie herself suggested, may make a fine piece of theater.
未锈铠： 事实上，这场战役某人亦参与其中。某人认为这是一个相当有趣的故事，夏利小姐曾建议某人将其改编为戏剧。

A Knight: If you would, Someone would very much like to perform it with you.
未锈铠： 请允许某人从头开始讲述这个故事。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

路途如砥石
Thorny Is the Way TNV-05

Thorny Is the Way
路途如砥石

A Knight: Lady Oder is a brave and wise woman ... Someone thought it would be an ideal role for Ms. An-an.
未锈铠：奥德骑士是一位英勇且充满智慧的女性……嗯，某人认为很适合由安安小姐来扮演。

A Knight: The other character of this play is the brave knight called Roland.
未锈铠：另一个出场的人物，是一位名叫罗兰的骑士。

A Knight: At that time, Sir Roland was still just a youth.
未锈铠：那时候的罗兰骑士，还是一个年轻得过分的小伙子。

A Knight: Rather alike in age to Sir Oliver now.
未锈铠：和现在的奥利弗先生很相似。

Oliver Fog checks his timepiece conspicuously.
雾行者看了一下钟表。

Oliver Fog : If I must. But may I remind you that this is my leisure time? I'm under no obligation to stay.
雾行者：好吧，未锈铠先生，不过我需要提醒一下你——现在是休息时间。

Oliver Fog : So I caution you not to make this little play of yours too long.
雾行者：希望这个戏剧排演不会占据太长的时间。

A Knight: Naturally, this will be a short but glorious story of a brave and noble woman.
未锈铠：当然，这本身就是一个简短、精悍、颇具传奇色彩的骑士故事。

A Knight: As for the giant Felgert ...
未锈铠：至于那个名为菲尔格特的巨人……

A Knight: He was 15 feet tall, morbidly rotund, mangy, and bald—
未锈铠：那家伙高达 15 英尺，臃肿异常、遍布癞疮，头发更是屈指可数——

A Knight looks around the room.
未锈铠环顾了一圈。

A Knight: Unfortunately, of those present here, only A Knight can be said to be of comparable stature to the grotesque giant.
未锈铠：很遗憾，在座的诸位中，只有某人的身高与他颇为相似。

A Knight: It falls reluctantly upon Someone's shoulders to take on the role of the gruesome Felgert.
未锈铠：某人勉为其难地扮演这位名为菲尔格特的巨人。

APPLe: And what of brave and true Sir APPLe?
APPLe：APPLe 某呢?

A Knight: The play has run short of speaking roles. Hmm, but I recall Felgert often threw ... rocks, as a means of attack.
未锈铠：据某人的回忆，这名巨人常以投掷石块作为攻击方式。

A Knight: Knowing that Sir APPLe is well-versed in special effects ...
未锈铠：而您似乎很擅长作自由落体运动。

A Knight: Someone swears not to toss you too roughly—
未锈铠：如果您愿意的话……

APPLe: In that case, this APPLe would prefer to work behind the scenes.
APPLe： 相比来说，APPLe 某还是更愿意作为幕后人员。

APPLe: Perhaps you are in need of a lighting technician?
APPLe： 灯光师怎么样?

A Knight: Superb sir! As Ms. Charlie has said, a skilled lighting technician can add tremendous value to a play.
未锈铠： 好极了，夏利小姐曾说过，一个优秀的灯光师能为剧目增色许多。

"Narrator": Now, Someone will act as your humble narrator.
“旁白”： 接下来，就由某人为诸位担任旁白。

"Narrator": At the beginning of this show, Lady Oder was not yet a knight.
“旁白”： 在最开始，奥德骑士并不是一名骑士。

"Narrator": Yet she was born to a noble family of great esteem. Indeed, Someone's own close friend, the Knight, Sir Oliver, was born into their house.
“旁白”： 她出生于一个显赫的贵族门庭。而某人的密友——奥利弗骑士亦出生于此。

"Narrator": At this time, high-born ladies could choose to wear luxurious dresses, wiling their hours away in the market with the other ladies, living as dainty things capable of fainting at a moment's notice.
“旁白”： 在那时，贵族小姐们可以选择穿奢华的裙子，和女眷们一起出去逛街，并在恰到好处的时候晕倒。

"Narrator": Or they could choose to familiarize themselves with Latin, so that they might recite Scripture. They would learn proper etiquette and ballroom dancing to be fit as a properly studied lady.
“旁白”： 也可以选择熟习拉丁文，诵读经卷，在老师的指引下学习礼仪或者交谊舞。

"Narrator": But no matter their choices, their lord father—who held the true power of decision over them—worried over only one thing.
“旁白”： 但无论她们如何选择，她们的父亲——那个真正具有决策权的人，自始至终只会担心一件事情。

"Narrator": —That is, how he might marry them off properly and advantageously.
“旁白”： ——那就是，如何把她们妥帖、合算地嫁出去。

"Narrator": Ms. An-an, stand tall, you will not be so fragile as these delicate ladies. For Lady Oder is of an entirely different sort.
“旁白”： 安安小姐，您不用演得过于柔弱，奥德骑士并不是这样的贵族小姐。

"Narrator": She was an unruly child, who only grew in her rebellion and courage, despite the sighing protestations of her mother.
“旁白”： 她有些过于顽劣了，总是让她的母亲唉声叹气。

"Oder": Is that so? Hyah!
“奥德”： 那这样呢？嘿～哈！

"Narrator": Bravo! A swift and powerful thrust, that is indeed more like our Lady Oder.
“旁白”： 棒极了【bravo】，很利落的动作，这才是奥德小姐会做的事。

"Narrator": But her father had little patience for her rebellious ways.
“旁白”： 而奥德小姐的父亲，并不在乎她怎么想。

"Narrator": He resolved that he must arrange a marriage for her early—before her rebellious spirit set in too deep. For to him, her value was as nothing more than what she could bring him as a bride.
“旁白”： 既然女儿顽劣，那就让她早早地定下婚约——毕竟在他看来，女儿的价值仅止于此。

"Narrator": To him a noble daughter was like a Bordeaux wine, or a ruby red as pigeon's blood ...
“旁白”： 正如一支波尔多的葡萄酒，或是一块鸽子血似的红宝石……

"Narrator": Things that he sneered upon as frivolous fancies behind closed doors, yet nonetheless had to rely on to maintain the prestige of his noble house.
“旁白”： 那些他总是在暗地里嘲笑华而不实，却又不得不借助它们，好让自己的身份显得更加高贵的东西。

"Narrator": Messengers wore out their shoes with their coming and going, until her father struck a deal with some far-flung nobleman he had never even met.
“旁白”： 来往的掮客磨破了鞋底，终于让她的父亲与一位从未谋面的贵族达成了契约。

"Narrator": So that after the coming of our Lady Oder's sixteen year, she would be wed to an aged lord well past his fifties.
“旁白”： ——在奥德小姐年满十六岁时，她就要嫁给一个年逾五十的老贵族。

"Roland": A rich old creep like that must have paid a king's ransom.
“罗兰”： ……老贵族一定允诺了很多条件。

"Narrator": "Roland," you're not on yet. Does Someone need to remind you of the importance of "quiet on set"?
“旁白”： “罗兰”先生，您现在还没有出场呢。

"Narrator": This story does not foreclose the exact terms of their arrangement.
“旁白”： 某人可以回答您的是，没有人知道契约的具体内容。

"Narrator": But it is said that during that time, Lady Oder's father began to exhibit behavior quite different from usual.
“旁白”： 但奥德的父亲在那一段时间，的确展露出了与平时大为不同的迹象。

"Narrator": It may well be that to increase one's worldly possessions is to enhance one's self-esteem.
“旁白”： 也许是身外物确实能助长人的自尊。

"Narrator": For during those days, her lord father seemed to have taken on an air of levity and laughter, smiling even on slights that had once had set him to rage.
“旁白”： 那几天，面对他人或有心或无意的冒犯，他终于也能学着一笑置之了。

"Narrator": Until one morning, when the laughter faded—
“旁白”： 不过，在某一天早上，他彻底地笑不出来了——

"Narrator": For Lady Oder had run away towards Brittany, leaving her father only a letter.
“旁白”： 奥德小姐在给他留了一封书信之后，独自前往了布列塔尼要塞。

"Roland": One can hardly blame her, though I for one, hope that she'd chop off the old man's head—give 'em the old Cromwell treatment.
“罗兰”： 显而易见，她要么会离开，要么会去砍下那个老贵族的头——就像克伦威尔那样。

"Narrator": An intriguing plot suggestion, to be sure.
“旁白”： 有趣的假设。

"Narrator": In those days, the journey to Brittany was fraught with all manner of dangers.
“旁白”： 那时，前往布列塔尼的路途十分危险。

"Narrator": For in addition to the rougher sorts one may find in Brittany, one could also chance upon a roving band of Saxons, Lombards, or Saracens at any time.
“旁白”： 除了布列塔尼人以外，随时可能会遇到撒克逊、伦巴底和萨拉森的军队或者探子。

"Narrator": Fortunately, our heroine was an able rider—the equal of any experienced knight.
“旁白”： 好在她的骑术非常优秀，不输于任何一个征战多年的骑士。

"Narrator": And so it was that Someone first laid eyes upon Lady Oder, just as she arrived at the gates of the Castle of Brittany.
“旁白”： 某人第一次见到奥德小姐时，她刚刚抵达布列塔尼要塞。

"Narrator": She still wore the gown of a noble lady, though her skirts had been torn in the bushes of that rough country. Her many days of riding left her in utter exhaustion, so that as she leaped from the saddle, she nearly stumbled on the ground.
“旁白”： 那时她还穿着贵族小姐的裙子，宽大的裙摆被灌木划得破烂。
连日的骑行让她疲惫不堪，以至于从马鞍上跃下的时候，还险些摔了一跤。

"Narrator": But her eyes shone as brightly as a tempered blade.
“旁白”： 但她的眼睛亮得如同一柄淬火的利剑。

"Narrator": Ms. An-an, this is your cue.
“旁白”： 安安小姐，轮到您说台词了。

"Oder": ... Oh!
“奥德”： ……哦！

"Oder": "Are you Sir Roland? I see nothing so special about you as to be worthy of your fame."
“奥德”： “你就是罗兰？我看你也没什么稀奇的。”

"Narrator": In her words, if not yet her deeds, she would soon transform from a young woman into a warrior.
“旁白”： 后来，她就从一名小姐，转变为了一名战士。

"Narrator": I must admit, she proved an unparalleled talent in battle.
“旁白”： 某人必须承认，她很有作战的天赋。

"Narrator": During those years in Brittany, she joined us in countless battles, winning one victory after another.
“旁白”： 在布列塔尼的那几年，她参加了数不尽的战役，一个捷报接着另一个捷报。

"Narrator": Her achievements were remarkable. Her feats became a most dazzling gem on a scepter—impossible for any to ignore.
“旁白”： 她的功绩是那样的卓越，如同权杖上最夺目的那块宝石，谁也无法忽略。

"Narrator": There had been no precedent for a woman warrior such as her. But after much deliberation, the cardinals agreed to grant her knighthood.
“旁白”： 在此之前，并没有女士被授封为骑士的先例。但枢机主教们经过漫长的思索之后，最终还是将她的授封仪式推上了日程。

"Narrator": However, the day before the ceremony, she bade Sir Roland to free her from her service.
“旁白”： 然而在授封的前一天，她却向某人提出了辞呈。

"Oder": "Sir Roland, I beg you to forgive me, but I cannot attend the ceremony."
“奥德”： “罗兰骑士，很抱歉，我无法出席那个授封仪式了。”

"Roland": "Why? Is it not your greatest dream to become a knight?"
“罗兰”： “为什么？你明明一直想要成为一名骑士。”

"Roland": "Getting those old-fashioned cardinals to agree to knight a woman was no easy feat."
“罗兰”： “让那些古板的主教们同意让一位女士当骑士，这不是一件容易的事。”

"Oder": "Do you remember my lord father, Roland?"
“奥德”： “您还记得我的父亲吗?”

"Oder": "He has learned that I was in Brittany and has been writing to me, urging me to return so that I might fulfill my long-neglected duties."
“奥德”： “这些年，他不知从什么地方得知了我在布列塔尼，一直在写信催促我回去，好继续他那未完成的交易。”

"Oder": "He has sent me another letter, a final warning, saying that if I continue in my rebellion—"
“奥德”： “他向我发出了最后的警告，如果我不按照他的想法去行动——”

"Oder": "He will send his champion, the giant Felgert to 'ask' me to come home."
“奥德”： “他会让一位名叫菲尔格特的巨人，‘请’我回去。”

"Oder": "You can see how he describes this terrible giant in his letter."
“奥德”： “您瞧瞧，他在这封信里把那个巨人写得多么可怕。”

"Oder": "15 feet tall, covered in scabies and pustules."
“奥德”： “15 英尺高，浑身长满了癞疮与脓包。”

"Oder": "He keeps the company of witches and has impenetrable skin."
“奥德”： “还曾与女巫做过交易，拥有着堪称刀枪不入的皮肤。”

"Roland": "So then, you'll do as he wishes and return home?"
“罗兰”： “那么，你要按照他说的那样，回去吗?”

"Narrator": A most stirring performance, Ms. An-an. But we must see your smile; let it be fierce and true!
“旁白”： 安安小姐，您的表演很好，此刻还需要展露一个笑容。

"Narrator": Superb. The exact emotion on display.
“旁白”： 对，好极了，就是这样。

"Oder": "Sir Roland, for as many years as we have fought side-by-side, it is a pity you don't know me better."
“奥德”： “罗兰骑士，很遗憾，您还是不够了解我。”

"Narrator": Mr. APPLe, the time comes to begin the scene of the climactic battle against the giant.
“旁白”： APPLe 先生，接下来我们要开始讨伐巨人的情节。

"Narrator": Please adjust the brightness of the stage light, a bit brighter still, if you please.
“旁白”： 需要您调整一下光线的亮度，最好能再亮一些。

"Narrator": For the sky that day was a stark and brilliant blue, dotted with white clouds floating above like a silken canopy.
“旁白”： 那一天的天空有着透彻的蓝色，而白云则飘浮着，像是一丛柔软的树冠。

"Narrator": A day that Someone returns to often in memory.
“旁白”： 某人到现在还时常回忆起那一天。

APPLe: Aye-aye.
APPLe： 好的。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

书信末端
So Concludeth the Epistle TNV-06

So Concludeth the Epistle
书信末端

"Roland": "Hahaha, evil giant, tremble in fear, for today you shall meet Sir Roland in the field."
“罗兰”: “哈哈哈，邪恶的巨人，可惜你今天遇到了罗兰。”

"Roland": "Now your devil's luck has run thin!"
“罗兰”: “算你倒了大霉！”

"Roland": ...
“罗兰”: ……

"Roland": Mr. Knight, are you entirely sure this is Sir Roland's line?
“罗兰”: 未锈铠先生，这真的是罗兰骑士的台词吗?

A Knight: Ahem ...
“旁白”: 咳咳……

A Knight: Someone reminds you that Sir Roland then was still a spirited young man.
“旁白”: 某人说过了，那时候的他，还是一个年轻气盛的小伙子。

A Knight: It was time now to face the giant.
“旁白”: 总之，经过了漫长的跋涉，他们见到了菲尔格特。

A Knight: The giant was just as the letter warned and more, for Felgert was of a monstrous height, and his bare skin was covered with mange and pustules.
“旁白”: 如同书信中所说的那样，菲尔格特拥有着 15 英尺的身高，裸露的皮肤上生满了癞疮与脓包。

"Roland": "Allow me!"
“罗兰”: “我先上！”

A Knight: Sir Roland spurred his horse onwards and charged Felgert.
“旁白”: 罗兰骑士用双腿一夹马腹，朝菲尔格特冲了过去。

"Roland": Uh, Mr. Knight, how can I spur my house? Do you see any horses about?
“罗兰”: 可是我们现在没有马。

A Knight: Hm ... a fair point indeed.
“旁白”: 嗯……您说的对。

A Knight: Perhaps Someone will seek the aid of Mr. Darley Clatter to play the role of Roland's steed.
“旁白”: 也许某人应该去征求哒哒达利先生的意见，也许它会愿意加入我们的剧目。

A Knight: Yet in the meantime, you need to only pretend to be riding a horse.
“旁白”: 总之，“罗兰”先生，现在请您假装自己骑着一匹马。

A Knight: As you say your next line.
“旁白”: 然后说出接下来的台词。

"Roland": "Bedeviled giant, today you face your doom!"
“罗兰”: “卑劣的巨人，今天我就会战胜你。”

A Knight: Sir Roland cried out at the pinnacle of his charge.
“旁白”: 罗兰骑士一边冲刺，一边这样说着。

A Knight: As he raised the Everlasting Sword high and brought it down on the giant's ankle—
“旁白”: 他高高地举起了手中的恒常之剑，向巨人的脚踝砍了下去——

A Knight: The blade collided with the giant's ankle, sliding as if across a sheet of uneven metal, sending forth a shower of yellow sparks.
“旁白”： 剑锋与脚踝相撞，就像是两块金属撞击，甚至还迸溅出了金色的火花。

A Knight: The blow had left the giant entirely unharmed. It served only to set the brute into a fitful anger.
“旁白”： 这一剑没有伤害到巨人，反而彻底地激怒了他。

A Knight: The giant reached out his hand, snatching Roland from his horse, and held him high in the air.
“旁白”： 他伸手一挥，从马背上抓起了罗兰骑士，并将他高高举起。

A Knight: Frightened, his warhorse ran off into the distance, never to be seen again.
“旁白”： 战马受到了惊吓，沿着远方跑去，再也找不到踪迹。

A Knight: Just as the battle looked to be lost, Lady Oder furrowed her brow, drew her long sword, and charged.
“旁白”： 战况胶着，奥德骑士拧紧了眉毛，拔出长剑，也冲了上去。

"Oder": "Ah—"
“奥德”： “呀——”

A Knight: She leaped from her horse high into the air, and drew a long slash across Felgert's bulbous belly.
“旁白”： 她从马背上高高跃起，将长剑横劈在菲尔格特的肚子上。

A Knight: Accompanying her strike came the self-same shower of yellow sparks.
“旁白”： 同样的金色火花。

A Knight: But this time the giant let out a gurgling hiss of pain.
“旁白”： 但巨人却发出了痛苦的嘶鸣。

"Roland": "The navel, the navel—"
“罗兰”： “肚脐眼，肚脐眼——”

A Knight: Sir Roland shouted breathlessly.
“旁白”： 罗兰骑士像是发现了什么东西，大声喊道。

A Knight: Oder heard him and turned to look at Felgert.
“旁白”： 奥德听到那声音，回头望向菲尔格特。

A Knight: There had been no trace of damage in her slash across Felgert's belly, save for a hint of blood around his putrid belly button.
“旁白”： 只见菲尔格特的肚皮上毫发无伤，只有肚脐眼上有一条淡淡的血痕。

"Oder": "Aha, I've found the heel of Achilles!"
“奥德”： “原来他的弱点，在肚脐眼！”

A Knight: Lady Oder's heart filled with hope at the thought. And she raised her sword again—
“旁白”： 奥德骑士这样想着，内心顿时充满了希望。她再次举起了长剑——

A Knight: But the giant's rage was directed elsewhere. His grip on Roland began to tighten.
“旁白”： 而菲尔格特此时到达了愤怒的极点，他的手指开始收紧。

A Knight: Sir Roland gave out an agonized scream!
“旁白”： 罗兰骑士发出了不堪重负的惨叫！

"Roland": "Arghh—"
“罗兰”： “啊——”

A Knight: But Oder's sword proved the swifter tool, as she pierced the giant's navel in the nick of time!
“旁白”： 幸运的是，在千钧一发之际，奥德手中的剑刺入了巨人的肚脐！

A Knight: The goliath shuddered and collapsed.
“旁白”： 菲尔格特颤抖着倒下了。

A Knight: But in death, the giant's fingers remained tightly wrapped around the knight. And blood ran down his knuckles.
“旁白”： 他的手指紧紧合拢，指节上有着隐约的血迹。

A Knight: Oder withdrew her sword from the belly of the giant.
“旁白”： 奥德拔出了插在巨人肚脐中的剑。

A Knight: They had won the duel.
“旁白”： 他们就这样赢下了与巨人的对决。

A Knight: Mr. APPLe, the story is finished. You may lower the lights.
未锈铠： APPLe 先生，故事结束了，某人认为现在可以不需要灯光了。

The lights fade.
室内的灯光渐渐地暗了下来。

A Knight: What do you think of the story?
未锈铠： 这个故事如何?

Oliver Fog : It ended too soon. Your Lady Oder defeated the giant. She should go back to be honored for her accomplishment and become a true knight.
雾行者： 未锈铠先生，奥德骑士战胜了巨人，她应该带着功绩回去受封，成为一名真正的骑士。

Oliver Fog : Really, you've omitted the most crucial part. Perhaps some ivory tower snobs might appreciate your ambiguity, but the masses will demand a satisfactory end for your heroine.
雾行者： 你遗漏了这一点——而这才是观众们最爱看的情节。

An-an Lee: I agree! The story ends too soon! Lady Oder deserves more to her tale!
泥鳐的士： 还有噶，这个皇帝好孤寒哦。

An-an Lee: She should return to the castle and be generously rewarded with land and riches!
泥鳐的士： 我要是皇帝，一定会给她好鬼多赏赐，像什么地啦，钱啦。

An-an Lee: With enough wealth of her own, she might go back and build her own house—so that she could have a new future away from her father.
泥鳐的士： 她有了地和钱，就可以回去起屋了——屋子可是好东西哦。

A Knight: I confess, sadly, that Lady Oder never was to be knighted. For even after besting the giant, she chose to leave Brittany. She carried on, ever dedicated to the life of freedom she had long sought.
未锈铠： 事实上，奥德女士最终没有被授封为骑士，她在战胜了巨人之后，便离开了布列塔尼，去追寻她一直向往的自由。

A Knight: She traveled far and wide across the land in those days, and when she could, she would write to Sir Roland and Oliver recounting her adventures.
未锈铠： 她在战胜了巨人之后，在四方游历。遇到有趣的事，她就会将它写下来，告知某人和奥利弗。

A Knight: She won a castle in a duel, and ever unwilling to be tied to the land, she chose to distribute its treasure among the local peasants. A story of that persists in legend.
未锈铠： 她在决斗中赢下了一座城堡，随后将里面的宝藏分发给了当地的农民，一时被传为佳话。

A Knight: Later still, she met Lady Berguin, with whom she shared many interests. They became lifelong friends and the closest of confidantes.
未锈铠：再后来，她结识了一位伯格音女士，她们志趣相投，变成了无话不谈的密友。

A Knight: Of course, her letters were the source of much inspiration, and many of Someone's greatest jokes.
未锈铠：——当然，她的信件也为某人提供了很多笑话的灵感。

A Knight: Someone cannot truly know if Lady Oder was satisfied with this ending.
未锈铠：不知道奥德女士是否满意这个结局。

A Knight: Yet it is enough to say the story is true.
未锈铠：某人现在所讲述的，是一个近乎真实的故事。

A Knight: Although, it must be confessed, for ease of narration, some slight adjustments were made.
未锈铠：虽然，为了讲述上的方便，某人对部分情节作了轻微的修改。

All: Boo—
众：嘘——

A Knight's little audience are clearly unhappy with this ending. A Knight seems to pause, as if taken at a loss for words.
观众们显然对这个结局并不满意。

Oliver Fog : Even if I disagree with the institution of landed nobility on principle, I see no reason why she couldn't be knighted before she goes off on her travels.
雾行者：我认为，故事中还是应该加上受封仪式——奥德完全可以在成为骑士之后，再去四方游历。

An-an Lee: And if nothing else, why was she never given a reward for killing that giant?! That's not fair!
泥鳐的士：还有！皇帝也要给她很多很多的赏赐！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

旧幽默
A Jest Anew TNV-07

A Jest Anew
旧幽默

The old story has ended, and a new one is about to begin.
旧故事终结，而新故事正要开始。

The undying flames of the candles cast warm yellow halos on the faces of the audience.
永不熄灭的烛火燃烧着，暖黄色的光晕映照在听众的脸庞上。

A Knight: It would be best to move on. Allow Someone to introduce the rules of the Comic Knight Festival.
未锈铠：现在，请允许某人再为诸位介绍一遍骑士笑话节的规则。

A Knight: First, there is need of a large space, one big enough for all the participants to gather around.
未锈铠：首先，需要有一块大场地，足够参会的所有人围坐在一起。

A Knight: The hall in the suitcase may prove suitable—hm, perhaps Someone ought to ask Vertin's permission, as she is the owner of the suitcase.
未锈铠：某人认为箱中大厅就很不错——嗯，这一点也许需要征求维尔汀的同意，她才是箱子的主人。

An-an Lee: Alright! It sounds like it will be fun!
泥鳐的士：哇，真系唔错！

A Knight: Each participant needs to prepare some jokes ... Any kind will do.
未锈铠：每个参会的人都需要准备一些笑话……什么样的都可以。

A Knight: Then, this little green bird will decide the order of show—simply put, whoever the bird's beak points to will be the next to tell their joke.
未锈铠：然后，这只绿色的小鸟会替我们决定顺序——简单地说，鸟喙指向谁，谁就是下一个说笑话的人。

A Knight points his gauntlet towards the little bird.
未锈铠指向那只小鸟。

A Knight: Someone has not arranged such a gathering with so many friends in many centuries.
未锈铠：这是某人第一次与如此之多的朋友举行这一场盛会。

A Knight: It must go over well. Someone must make sure of that.
未锈铠：这也正是某人近日深感苦恼之处。

A Knight: Yet, fashions and fads change with the seasons. How can anyone keep up with the latest in comedic wit?
未锈铠：时尚与风潮总是变得很快，某人新学的俏皮话总在过时。

A Knight: Someone had hoped to acquire new material worthy of the upcoming festival.
未锈铠：某人还需要还收集一些题材，以便在即将到来的笑话节中大放异彩。

An-an Lee: Sir, you're right that fashion has changed. Maybe I can help!
泥鳐的士：sir，时代变啦！

An-an Lee: I think that these days people like to hear ghost stories! You should try telling a joke that involves ghosts.
泥鳐的士：现代的人都喜欢听鬼故事！或许你试试讲一个鬼故事笑话。

An-an Lee: Something that might be both scary and funny!
泥鳐的士：保准又吓人又好笑啦！

A Knight does not reply. The armor sits motionless with a hand posing under an invisible chin.
未锈铠陷入沉思。

APPLe: This APPLe once heard Ms. Titor tell a joke about apples.
APPLe：APPLe 某曾听到提托小姐说过一个关于苹果的笑话。

APPLe: "Nowadays, you are worthless in IT unless you have a byte."
APPLe：“现在的你在 IT 行业毫无价值，除非你被咬上一口。”

APPLe: This APPLe still doesn't quite understand the joke. But Ms. Titor sure seemed to enjoy it.
APPLe：APPLe 某至今都不明白这个笑话的意思，IT【it】是大写的人称代词吗?

Oliver Fog : Programming, ghost stories, it's all dull—dull, dull, dull.
雾行者：这一点也不好笑。

Oliver Fog : The only thing that makes me smile these days is an upcoming vacation.
雾行者：我对这些没什么兴趣……最令人轻松的消息就是一纸休假通知。

Oliver Fog shrugs, staring distantly out the window before returning.
雾行者耸了耸肩。

Oliver Fog : Still, out of deepest respect to you, I'll join in on your joke festival.
雾行者：但我会来参加这个节日。

A Knight: Someone could not help but feel honored.
未锈铠：某人深感荣幸。

Their discussion on stories and comedy soon begins to wind down, as the sky of the suitcase fades from sunset into darkness.
经过简单的讨论，天色渐渐地暗了下来。

An-an Lee: Sir Knight, I have to go. I have a field deployment tomorrow morning.
泥鳐的士：铠 sir，我先回去了。明天早上还要出外勤噶。

Oliver Fog : I must leave as well.
雾行者：我也要走了。

A Knight: Fare thee well, friends. Someone hopes that the coming festival will not disappoint.
未锈铠：希望某人不会令各位的期待落空。

The young guests shuffle their way out of the room, more content than they'd arrived.
年轻的客人们陆续离开了房间。

The lights flicker, and the room falls quiet for a time.
灯火晃动，房间内又回到了最开始的寂静。

A Knight: Mr. APPLe, you're the only one who heard both stories.
未锈铠：APPLe 先生，您是唯一听了两个故事的听众。

A Knight: If you were to compare them, which story did you like more?
未锈铠：相较而言，您更喜欢哪个故事呢?

APPLe: This APPLe preferred the story in which Sir Roland visited the Queen of the Moors.
APPLe：APPLe 某更喜欢那个拜访摩尔人女王的故事。

A Knight: Why do you think that, sir?
未锈铠：为什么?

APPLe: It seems you had intended to create a light, humorous, and lively atmosphere for the story of Lady Oder ...
APPLe：虽然您极力想为奥德骑士的故事营造出一个轻松、幽默、活泼的氛围——

APPLe: But whether you claim it to be the truth or not, its all-too-quick and sappy resolution clearly tells another tale.
APPLe：但敏感的读者依然能觉察到，事情的真相并不是如此。

A Knight: ...
未锈铠：……

A Knight: What a pity.
未锈铠：某人深表遗憾。

A Knight: So, what was the truth of her ending ...
未锈铠：那么，另一种结局又是什么样的呢?

Roland: —No!!!
罗兰：——不!!!

The Everlasting Sword has failed to pierce Felgert's body in time.
恒常之剑没入了菲尔格特的躯体。

Doing his best to control his trembling hands, he draws his sword out from the crumpled giant's belly, inch by inch.
他竭力控制住颤抖且发软的双手，一寸一寸地拔出了剑。

Then, summoning all his courage, he looks towards the giant's right hand.
然后，他鼓起勇气看向了巨人的右手。

The brute's hands are balled in a tight fist, and crimson blood drips down its knuckles.
那只手紧紧握着，上面有些轻微的血迹。

There is no life stirring within the balled hand, but no sign of Lady Oder either.
除此以外，再无他物。

Roland: ... Oder?
罗兰：……奥德?

For a moment, he feels some hope rising within him once more. With what strength he has left, he searches for any sign of Oder in the fields around him.
他忽然又燃起了希望，用所剩无几的力气，在附近寻找奥德的身影。

...
……

The giant has thrown his stone. Now only the wind remains with him standing in the field.
四周只有寂寥的风声。

A bird flies up from the edge of the field, carrying Oder's ribbon in its beak, soaring away into the vast blue sky.
他看见远处飞来了一只鸟，它衔着奥德的绸带，飞向了更广阔的蓝天。

The bird is green, with long tail feathers, but its belly has been painted in a hauntingly familiar crimson.
那只鸟通体绿色，有着几道长长的尾羽，胸腹是美丽的朱红色。

Knight II: My Lord Margrave, we found a letter among Oder's effects.
骑士 II：罗兰阁下，我们在奥德女士的遗物中找到了一些信件。

Knight II: It was addressed to you.
骑士 II：上面的收件人是您。

英文 / ENGLISH
Sir Roland:

If you are reading this letter, then I have reached the end of my journey.
I must confess a secret, for Oliver confided in me that he has always enjoyed our jokes.
Please, don't be cross, Sir Oliver.
I could not bear to go to my death without revealing a punchline.
Roland, should you ever mention me to anyone,
please make sure there is a fitting ending to my story,
one fit for me—believe me, I'll hear about it.
I wish you good spirits, humor, and happiness, always.
A Knight

中文 / CHINESE
罗兰阁下：

你阅读到这封信时，我应当已经迎来了我的终章。
我必须要声明，奥利弗实际上很喜欢你的笑话。
如果……你要向别人提起我，请一定给我一个有趣的结局——
相信我，我会听见的。
此外，愿你平安。

一位骑士

A Knight: Sir APPLe as an educated fellow, you must have read the Greeks Tragedies. The greatest of them, the most tragic, came from those who made no mistake but suffered anyways.
未锈铠： 您一定读过希腊人的故事。他们就喜欢写这样的东西——没有一个人犯错，但悲剧还是不可避免地发生了。

A Knight: Someone has always had a soft spot for tragedy. Something about the darkness of a true tragedy speaks to a young knight.
未锈铠： 在很久很久以前，那些年轻的骑士们很喜欢这样的故事，某人也受到了一定程度的影响。

APPLe: Truly? It seems to me that young knights would prefer courtly romances and the tales of dashing knight-errants.
APPLe： APPLe 某以为，骑士们会倾向于观看骑士小说。

A Knight: You may think so, but in that time, those legends were only just being written, and it was the old knights who appreciated them. Perhaps because it allowed them to reminisce, or perhaps they enjoyed mocking the false endings the minstrels would invent.
未锈铠： 年纪大点的骑士喜欢看骑士小说，他们会时常谈论里面的情节，并且以行内人的视角去嘲笑作者的外行。

A Knight: And they would compare, over grumbles, the rewards written about in those tales with those of their own.
未锈铠： 同时，也会暗暗地将小说中写到的封赏与自己的酬劳相比较。

A Knight: It seemed that imaginary monarchs were so often more generous than the real ones.
未锈铠： 很显然，现实的君主远不如杜撰的君主慷慨。

A Knight: No, it seemed the younger knights and squires preferred tragedy ... Perhaps it was a fashion, or something that came upon them because so many had never seen true battle. Perhaps for them, it played to their ...
未锈铠： 至于希腊人写的悲剧，一般更受年轻骑士的青睐……他们还没有经历过太多的战役，还处在……

A Knight: Hm ... Today, it might be called ... "Teenage angst"?
未锈铠： 嗯……用现在的话来讲，大约是……“青春期的躁动”?

APPLe: Perhaps it was a longing for meaning, the younger man's foolish wish to die as a hero rather than an old man?
APPLe： APPLe 某认为，使用“对宏大叙事的憧憬”这个词更为贴切。

A Knight: Oh, yes, longing. Their eyes said as much.
未锈铠： 噢，是的，憧憬，他们的眼睛也说出了同样的词。

Without a doubt, many yearned for war.
毫无疑问地，他们向往战争。

Minstrels plucked the lire, their tongues as smooth as silk, painting war as a grand spectacle in their songs.
吟游诗人拨弄着里拉琴，他们巧舌如簧，用曼妙的歌声将战争描绘成一幕盛大的戏剧。

In the stories, blood would weave into a scarlet ribbon. Knights only needed to don it, and gold and glory would rain down upon them.
在那里，鲜血会编织成一条绛色的绶带。骑士们只需要将它佩戴在身上，黄金与声名便会如沙如土地向他们倾泻而来。

A Knight: Sir Roland once believed that as well.
未锈铠： 某人曾经也是这样认为的。

A Knight: Until the Battle of Roncevaux Pass.
未锈铠： 直到那一场发生在龙塞斯瓦耶斯隘口的战役。

A Knight: The story of that battle is the last recorded tale of "Roland" in history.
未锈铠： 那场战役，也是历史上所记载的，关于“罗兰”最后的故事。

A Knight: Sir Oliver had joined the ranks of the rearguard, standing alongside Sir Roland.
未锈铠： 奥利弗骑士亦随罗兰骑士一起上阵。

A Knight: He had advised against the stand they made that day ... No, I will speak the truth. It was more than that. He was afraid.
未锈铠： 他从没有提起过，但某人知道，奥利弗骑士抗拒战场……或者，用“惧怕”这个词，更为准确些。

A Knight: He had always been more adept as a strategist than a warrior.
未锈铠： 比起亲身参与战役，他更擅长作为一名幕僚而行动。

A Knight: But the situation in that battle had grown dire, with thousands of enemies surrounding them. The life of their sovereign was hanging in the balance of their action, so he had to take up arms and charge ahead.
未锈铠： 但那场战役的状况是如此危急，四周围绕着将近四十万的敌人。他所效忠的君主就在身后，他不得不拿上武器，冲锋在前。

A Knight: In the heavy melee, his face was wounded, and he lost his sight.
未锈铠： 鏖战之中，他的眼睛被划伤了。

A Knight: Sir Roland saw that he was injured and fought his way through the Basques to get close to him, intending to offer assistance.
未锈铠： 罗兰骑士见他受伤，便从巴斯克人中闯出一条路，驱马靠近了他，想要为他提供援助。

A Knight: But he mistook Sir Roland for an attacking enemy and struck him with his sword.
未锈铠： 但他将罗兰骑士误认为来袭的敌人，一剑拍在了他的脸上。

APPLe: What happened next?
APPLe： 后面发生了什么？

A Knight turns towards the window.
未锈铠望向了窗外。

A Knight: Allow Someone to continue in the role of "Sir Roland."
未锈铠： 请允许某人继续扮演那位“罗兰骑士”。

Mr. APPLe adjusts the lighting appropriately.
APPLe 先生适当地调整了灯光。

The story returns again to that day at twilight, as the battle unfolds in a distant land on a narrow pass.
多年前的某日，一如此刻的黄昏，在遥远的隘口，有一场战役正在发生。

There in that valley, the warrior Maganis comes galloping in on his warhorse, his lance ready.
马甘尼斯驾驶着战马，手持长枪疾驰而来。

He charges the lines of Sir Roland's men, riding with such speed that the point of his lance pierces straight and true through shield and hauberk. Through and out the body of a young knight.
他借着由速度带来的惯性，贯穿了奥利弗骑士的躯体。

Roland: Oliver!!!
罗兰： 奥利弗！！！

Sir Roland scrambles to Sir Oliver's side.
罗兰骑士拼尽全力，赶到了奥利弗骑士的身侧。

The young man's injuries are severe. His body growing colder and stiffer by the moment.
他的伤势非常严重，身体逐渐变得冰凉僵硬。

A Knight: Any knight knows perfectly well that there was no chance of survival from a wound such as this.
未锈铠：任何一个骑士都清楚地明白，受到这种贯穿伤不会有存活的可能。

A Knight: There were to be no miracles for Sir Oliver. His body was like a shattered clay pot, the flowing water of life pouring out from within.
未锈铠：奇迹没有垂怜奥利弗骑士，他的躯体如同一个被打破的陶罐，寓意着生命的水流正源源不断地从中涌出。

A Knight: Sir Roland would remember his last words to this very day.
未锈铠：他的遗言让罗兰骑士铭记至今。

A Knight: He said ...
未锈铠：他说……

A Knight: "What do you say when you find a ... a deer without any eyes?"
未锈铠：“没有眼睛的鹿……是什么鹿?”

A Knight: It was a terrible joke, and yet ... Someone laughed.
未锈铠：一个非常老套的笑话。

APPLe: Was that another one of your adaptations?
APPLe：这也是您进行的幽默化改编吗?

A Knight: No, this happened exactly as it was said. Someone was among that proud host of knights that day—every word of it is written indelibly on Someone's soul.
未锈铠：不，这是一场真实的“小战役”，某人有幸是众多骑士中最普通的一员——因此，才能够亲耳听见这句话。

APPLe: My deepest condolences then.
APPLe：抱歉。

A Knight: Mr. APPLe, you needn't apologize.
未锈铠：APPLe 先生，您无需抱歉。

A Knight: Sir Oliver's deeds of valor have endured—for him, too, death is far from the end.
未锈铠：更何况，奥利弗骑士的英勇事迹已流传至今——某人相信，对于他而言，死亡远非终点。

A Knight: Someone must state their earnest belief: that there is far greater power in comedy than most imagine.
未锈铠：某人只是想陈述这样一个观点：笑话中所蕴含的能量，远比人们想象的要多。

A Knight: Someone surely believes that the suitcase could have use of more levity in these dark times.
未锈铠：箱子里需要更多的幽默与笑话。

A Knight: So ... would you be willing to participate in the next Comic Knight Festival?
未锈铠：所以……您愿意来参加下一届的骑士笑话节吗?

A Knight: The festival date will be set on February 29.
未锈铠：某人准备于 2 月 29 日举办这个节日。

A Knight: Someone will eagerly await your reply.
未锈铠：届时，某人将恭候您的光临。

"Humility, honesty, mercy, valor, justice, sacrifice, honor, soul."

"And, of course, a bit of humor."
“谦卑、诚实、怜悯、英勇、公正、牺牲、荣誉、灵魂。”

“当然，也包含了一点小小的幽默。”

THE END
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